

was performed. Although the response was generally favorable, performers resented his intolerant manner, and Vienna's anti-Semites mounted a damaging campaign against him on racial grounds.

Masterpieces continued to flow from his holidays, now chiefly spent at Wörthersee in southern Austria—the Fourth Symphony in 1900, the Fifth Symphony in 1902, the song cycle *Kindertotenlieder* (Songs on the Death of Children) in 1904, and the Sixth, Seventh, and Eighth Symphonies between 1904 and 1906. Mahler's music was challenging, stretching the symphonic tradition to its limits. It was emotionally jarring in its ironic use of popular tunes, tonally adventurous, and formally innovative, employed unusual instruments, and often included songs and choral elements. But his works were not excessively out of step with public taste and were sometimes received with enthusiasm. However, he envied the wider fame of Richard Strauss, then celebrated as the hero of German new music.